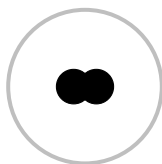


SPROLL 09

Parts With a Past



a whole that still remembers its pieces

The Sproll Curriculum · Cycle I: Pops

The Sproll Curriculum

Cycle I — Pops: Things, Differences, and Counting

Sproll 09 of 40 · follows Sproll 08: When Are They Equal?

[Illustration: a single dot from Sproll 00, small in a corner, as a callback]

● Sproll 00 asked:

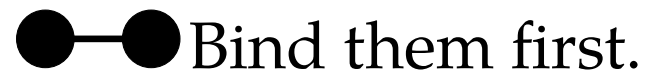
Can many things be treated as one?

[Illustration: two dots sitting near each other, not connected by any line]

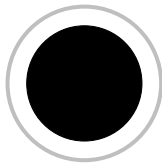
● ● Rule: treat bound things as one.

These are not bound. Still two.

[Illustration: the same two dots, now connected by the Bind line from Sproll 05]



[Illustration: the same bound pair, now shown Collapsed under the merging rule into a single larger rounded shape]



Now the rule can call them one.

[Illustration: no new image; the unbound pair and the bound-then-merged single shape shown together for comparison]

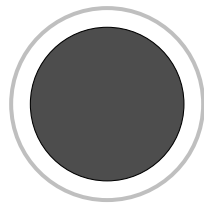
  Being near each other isn't enough.

Being bound is what the rule needs.

[Illustration: three shapes, a dot, a triangle, and a square, all connected to each other by Bind lines]



[Illustration: the same three pieces, now Collapsed under the merging rule into one larger whole shape]



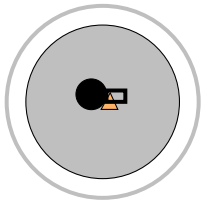
One whole.

[Illustration: a ledger showing three Pop entries and two Bind entries, the full record behind the whole]

●
▲
□
—
—

Ask the history: what made this?

[Illustration: the single whole shape from page 9, with a faint, ghostly outline of the three original pieces still visible inside it]



The whole does not erase its parts.

The history still remembers them.

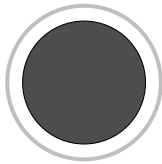
[Illustration: a simple toy shape (say, a small toy car) built from a few visible interlocking blocks]



A toy built from blocks is one toy.

It is still blocks.

[Illustration: the whole shape from before, calm and settled, no ghost outline this time]



One thing, and many things,

are both true, at the same time.

[Illustration: small icons for all four primitives shown together for the first time: a dot for Pop, a crossed-out shape for Refuse, a connecting line for Bind, and a simple lens shape for Collapse]



What can you build with all of them together?

— turn the page for Sproll 10: Four Moves Make a World —

A Note for Grown-Ups

This book resolves Sproll 00's second open question precisely: many things can be treated as one, but only once they have been Bound and then Collapsed under a rule that specifically merges bound elements. Proximity alone, without Bind, does not qualify, which the unbound-pair page exists to demonstrate directly rather than merely assert.

The ghost-outline illustration on page 11 is the book's central image: a Collapse into a whole is not a deletion of the parts, since the underlying history, Pops and Binds, still exists and can still be inspected. This is the beginning of historical mereology, part-whole relations built from events rather than assumed set membership, though this book does not use that term with the child.

Sproll 10: Four Moves Make a World continues directly from this book's final page.